Pembrolizumab every 6 weeks for head and neck cancer

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00558 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Your practical treatment plan

Pembrolizumab 400 mg is given through a vein over about 30 minutes on Day 1 every 6 weeks. The whole visit includes safety checks, preparation and observation. Treatment continues until progression or unacceptable toxicity. After 24 months of sustained response without progression, the team may consider stopping; stopping at 24 months is not automatic.

STEP 1

Appointments

Pembrolizumab 400 mg is given through a vein over about 30 minutes on Day 1 every 6 weeks. The whole visit includes safety checks, preparation and observation.

STEP 2

Course length

Treatment continues until progression or unacceptable toxicity. After 24 months of sustained response without progression, the team may consider stopping; stopping at 24 months is not automatic.

STEP 3

Tests and review

Full blood count, kidney and liver tests and glucose before every 6-week cycle. Thyroid tests every 3–6 weeks; cortisol when clinically indicated.

STEP 4

Home record

Carry your treatment record, actual urgent contacts and medicine list. Tell the team about line redness, swelling, leakage, pain or fever.

STEP 5

Follow-up

Keep reporting new symptoms after treatment ends. Steroid tapers, hormone replacement or specialist review may continue longer. Scans and examinations follow your individual response and follow-up plan.

Sources: NCCP 00558 v13: official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.